# EXISTENTIALISM

**EXISTENTIALISM AS A FAMILY → KIERKEGAARD: INDIVIDUAL, SUBJECTIVITY, SPHERES → HEIDEGGER: DASEIN, BEING-IN-THE-WORLD, EQUIPMENT → HEIDEGGER: THE THEY, ANXIETY → HEIDEGGER: TEMPORALITY, FUTURE PRIORITY → SARTRE: EXISTENCE, IN-ITSELF, FOR-ITSELF**

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

★ PRIMARY CORE FLOW · ◉ SUBORDINATE EXTRA · ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g4 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

## 00 — EXISTENTIALISM AS A FAMILY: COMMON PROBLEM, DISTINCT PROJECTS

FAMILY, NOT ONE SCHOOL · LIVED AND SITUATED EXISTENCE · FAITH / ONTOLOGY / FREEDOM · NOT NIHILISM OR SELF-HELP · EXACT ATTRIBUTION

**START → concrete lived existence resists reduction to abstract system or fixed nature.**

**EXISTING INDIVIDUAL → situated, finite, choosing and self-interpreting existence.** → **KIERKEGAARD → Christian inwardness, anti-Hegelian individual and self before God.** → **HEIDEGGER → fundamental ontology through Dasein and finite being-in-the-world.**

### COMMON ORIENTATION

- Concrete existence is lived, finite, situated and self-interpreting.
- Abstract systems and fixed natures can conceal the person who must choose.
- Individuality, anxiety, responsibility and authenticity recur across the family.

### THREE DISTINCT PROJECTS

- Kierkegaard: religious inward commitment and selfhood before God.
- Heidegger: fundamental ontology through finite being-in-the-world.
- Sartre: atheistic consciousness, nothingness and situated freedom.

### EXAMINER'S FILTER

- Do not universalise Sartre's slogan across all existentialists.
- Do not confuse anxiety with clinical fear or authenticity with nonconformity.
- Treat existentialism as a problem-field and preserve thinker-specific grounds.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Abstract system or fixed nature -> loss of the concrete individual -> return to lived existence -> three distinct projects of faith, ontology and freedom.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Existentialism is best treated as a family of projects united by the priority of lived, situated existence but divided over whether the self is grounded before God, disclosed through Being, or made through atheistic freedom.**

## 01 — KIERKEGAARD: INDIVIDUAL, SUBJECTIVITY, SPHERES, ANXIETY, DESPAIR AND FAITH

EXISTING INDIVIDUAL · SUBJECTIVITY != WHIM · SPHERES + ANXIETY + DESPAIR · LEAP / FAITH / ABRAHAM · RESPONSIBLE SELFHOOD

**SYSTEM → universal mediation loses the particular person who must exist and choose.**

**EXISTING INDIVIDUAL → temporal, passionate, responsible and irreducibly singular.** → **TRUTH IS SUBJECTIVITY → existential appropriation; NOT whatever I feel is true.** → **SPHERES → aesthetic immediacy; ethical duty; religious selfhood before God.**

### SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- SYSTEM → universal mediation loses the particular person who must exist and choose.
- EXISTING INDIVIDUAL → temporal, passionate, responsible and irreducibly singular.
- TRUTH IS SUBJECTIVITY → existential appropriation; NOT whatever I feel is true.
- SPHERES → aesthetic immediacy; ethical duty; religious selfhood before God.

### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- SPHERES → qualitative orientations crossed by decision, not automatic age-phases.
- POSSIBILITY → anxiety / dread → dizziness of freedom → choice → becoming a self.
- DESPAIR → not willing to be oneself OR defiantly willing without one's ground.
- LEAP / FAITH → lived God-relation; not mere caprice or evidence-free opinion.

### IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- ABRAHAM → teleological suspension clarifies faith and creates an ethical problem.
- VERDICT → responsible inwardness is powerful; public criteria remain incomplete.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** System vs individual -> existential appropriation -> qualitative spheres -> possibility and anxiety -> choice -> despair or faith -> responsible selfhood.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: For Kierkegaard, becoming a self requires the single individual to appropriate existential truth through responsible choice: anxiety discloses freedom, despair exposes misrelation, and faith claims to re-ground the self before God.**

## 02 — HEIDEGGER: DASEIN, BEING-IN-THE-WORLD, EQUIPMENT AND CARE

FUNDAMENTAL ONTOLOGY · UNITARY BEING-IN-THE-WORLD · READY / PRESENT AT HAND · CARE: THROWN PROJECTION · THEORY IS DERIVATIVE

**PROJECT → fundamental ontology; Heidegger resists Sartrean humanistic existentialism.** → **DASEIN → the being for whom Being is an issue; not mind or biological object.** → **BEING-IN-THE-WORLD → unitary structure; not subject inside a container-world.** → **WORLDHOOD → meaningful referential context of concern, projects and being-with.** → **READY-TO-HAND → absorbed equipment; breakdown reveals the in-order-to nexus.**

### SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- PROJECT → fundamental ontology; Heidegger resists Sartrean humanistic existentialism.
- DASEIN → the being for whom Being is an issue; not mind or biological object.
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### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- READY-TO-HAND → absorbed equipment; breakdown reveals the in-order-to nexus.
- PRESENT-AT-HAND → detached object of theory; derivative from practical involvement.
- CARE → ahead-of-itself + already-in a world + alongside entities.
- THROWNESS → unchosen given; PROJECTION → possibilities; FALLENNESS → absorption.

### IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- DAS MAN → ordinary public intelligibility; inauthenticity is not simple moral evil.
- BRIDGE → anxiety interrupts familiar significance and discloses finite possibility.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Question of Being -> Dasein -> being-in-the-world -> ready-to-hand nexus -> breakdown -> present-at-hand -> care as thrown projection and everyday absorption.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Heidegger replaces the detached subject with Dasein's unitary being-in-the-world, whose equipmental involvement and threefold care disclose thrown, projected and everyday existence before theoretical representation.**

## 03 — HEIDEGGER: THE THEY, ANXIETY, DEATH, RESOLUTENESS AND AUTHENTICITY

ANXIETY DISCLOSES FINITUDE · DEATH: OWN / CERTAIN / INDEFINITE · ANTICIPATORY RESOLUTENESS · AUTHENTIC != ISOLATED HERO · FINITE ECSTATIC TIME

### SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- DAS MAN → received meanings and average everydayness; structural, not wickedness.
- FEAR → determinate threat; ANXIETY → familiar significance recedes without one object.
- ANXIETY → discloses being-in-the-world and Dasein's ownmost finite possibility.
- DEATH → ownmost, non-relational, certain and indefinite possibility.

### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- NOT → suicide, death-seeking, morbid heroism or biological event alone.
- ANTICIPATION → individualises Dasein and exposes the finitude of every possibility.
- RESOLUTENESS → owning thrown possibilities within, not outside, the shared world.
- AUTHENTICITY → formal modification; not moral superiority or social isolation.

### IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- OBJECTION → normatively empty; death-centred and politically vulnerable resoluteness.
- VERDICT → strong ontology of ownership; thin guidance about which possibilities to own.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** The They's familiar meanings -> anxiety -> finite ownmost possibility -> anticipation -> resoluteness -> authentic ownership within the shared world.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Heideggerian authenticity is the resolute ownership of finite, thrown possibilities disclosed through anxiety and being-towards-death, not moral superiority, social retreat or fascination with biological dying.**

## 04 — HEIDEGGER: TEMPORALITY, FUTURE PRIORITY, HISTORICALITY AND LIMIT

TEMPORALITY = MEANING OF CARE · FUTURE / HAVING-BEEN / PRESENT · FINITE ECSTATIC UNITY · CLOCK-TIME IS DERIVATIVE · HISTORICALITY + INCOMPLETE PROJECT

**TEMPORALITY → meaning of care; not external clock-time surrounding Dasein.**

**FUTURE → projection, anticipation and ahead-of-itself; structurally primary.** → **HAVING-BEEN → thrownness and the inherited past Dasein still is.** → **PRESENT → involvement, making-present and being alongside entities.**

### SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- TEMPORALITY → meaning of care; not external clock-time surrounding Dasein.
- FUTURE → projection, anticipation and ahead-of-itself; structurally primary.
- HAVING-BEEN → thrownness and the inherited past Dasein still is.
- PRESENT → involvement, making-present and being alongside entities.

### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- ECSTASES → one finite unity, not compartments arranged on a time-line.
- ANTICIPATION → gathers thrown existence into a whole and links time to authenticity.
- VULGAR TIME → derivative public sequence of measurable nows.
- HISTORICALITY → inherited possibilities projected anew; history is how Dasein exists.

### IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- LIMIT → Division III was not published; Dasein's time does not complete ontology.
- BRIDGE → Sartre grounds open self-making in the for-itself's nothingness.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Care -> future projection + having-been thrownness + present involvement -> finite ecstatic unity -> authentic historicality -> derivative public now-series.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Heidegger's temporality is the finite ecstatic unity of future, having-been and present through which care becomes intelligible, not the external clock in which Dasein happens.**

## 05 — SARTRE: EXISTENCE, IN-ITSELF, FOR-ITSELF AND NOTHINGNESS

EXISTENCE PRECEDES ESSENCE · IN-ITSELF / FOR-ITSELF · NOTHINGNESS / NIHILATION · SARTRE'S HUMAN CLAIM ONLY · SELF AS PROJECT

**ARTEFACT → design or essence precedes manufactured existence.** → **HUMAN REALITY → no divine blueprint; existence precedes self-made essence.** → **SCOPE → Sartre's formula for human beings; not unchanged Kierkegaard or Heidegger.** → **BEING-IN-ITSELF → full, opaque, self-identical and simply what it is.** → **BEING-FOR-ITSELF → intentional consciousness, lack and non-self-coincidence.**

### SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- ARTEFACT → design or essence precedes manufactured existence.
- HUMAN REALITY → no divine blueprint; existence precedes self-made essence.
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- BEING-IN-ITSELF → full, opaque, self-identical and simply what it is.

### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- BEING-FOR-ITSELF → intentional consciousness, lack and non-self-coincidence.
- NOTHINGNESS / NIHILATION → distance, absence, negation, questions and alternatives.
- SELF-TRANSCENDENCE → consciousness exceeds past, role and present identity.
- PROJECT → provisional self-definition through action; never a completed fixed essence.

### IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- NOT MIND-BODY DUALISM → the contrast is ontological, not two substances.
- BRIDGE → the for-itself is free only within facticity and situation.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** No predetermined human design -> human first exists -> consciousness negates the given -> projects possibilities -> self is made without becoming a finished essence.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Sartre's existence-precedes-essence thesis depends on the for-itself's nothingness: consciousness is never a completed thing but a project that exceeds every identity it has.**

## 06 — SARTRE: SITUATED FREEDOM, CHOICE, RESPONSIBILITY AND ANGUISH

FACTICITY <-> TRANSCENDENCE · SITUATED FREEDOM · CHOICE -> RESPONSIBILITY · FREEDOM != POWER OR BLAME · ANGUISH / ABANDONMENT

**FACTICITY → body, past, social position, situation and events already suffered.**

**TRANSCENDENCE → surpassing the given through interpretation, projects and action.** → **SITUATED FREEDOM → constraints are real; no fact determines its own meaning.** → **FREEDOM != POWER → inability to alter every condition does not erase self-positioning.**

### SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- FACTICITY → body, past, social position, situation and events already suffered.
- TRANSCENDENCE → surpassing the given through interpretation, projects and action.
- SITUATED FREEDOM → constraints are real; no fact determines its own meaning.
- FREEDOM != POWER → inability to alter every condition does not erase self-positioning.

### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- CHOICE → even refusal, conformity or delay can position the self and its project.
- RESPONSIBILITY → for meanings and projects; NOT blame for every inflicted event.
- ANGUISH → no nature or rule guarantees what I choose and make of myself.
- ABANDONMENT → no divine value-giver; values cannot be outsourced to God.

### IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- DESPAIR → act without assuming history, luck or others will guarantee the outcome.
- LIMIT → early radicalism is qualified by later attention to material social constraints.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Factical situation -> interpretation and projected end -> choice -> responsibility for the project -> anguish because no essence guarantees it.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Sartrean freedom is radical because no fact interprets itself, yet situated because every project begins from facticity; responsibility concerns the meaning and direction one gives a life, not culpability for every injury imposed upon it.**

## 07 — SARTRE: IN-ITSELF, FOR-ITSELF, FACTICITY AND BAD FAITH

BAD FAITH: TWO-POLE FLIGHT · WAITER USED CAUTIOUSLY · AUTHENTICITY OWNS BOTH POLES · LOOK / SHAME / OBJECTIFICATION · SOCIAL AND ETHICAL LIMITS

**IN-ITSELF → full, opaque and self-identical; simply what it is.** → **FOR-ITSELF → intentional, nihilating and non-self-coincident consciousness.** → **FACTICITY → body, past, role and situation; TRANSCENDENCE → projected possibility.** → **BAD FAITH → flight from this tension; not ordinary lying alone.** → **ROLE FIXATION → pretend I am only my facticity and deny transcendence.**

### SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- IN-ITSELF → full, opaque and self-identical; simply what it is.
- FOR-ITSELF → intentional, nihilating and non-self-coincident consciousness.
- FACTICITY → body, past, role and situation; TRANSCENDENCE → projected possibility.
- BAD FAITH → flight from this tension; not ordinary lying alone.

### ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- ROLE FIXATION → pretend I am only my facticity and deny transcendence.
- PURE FREEDOM CLAIM → deny facticity and pretend no situation binds.
- WAITER → role-essentialism example; not proof that workers are inauthentic.
- DATE EXAMPLE → evasion of a gesture's meaning and the need to choose.

### IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- AUTHENTICITY → lucid ownership of both poles; less systematic than bad faith.
- LIMIT → self-deception paradox and thin ethics remain unresolved.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** For-itself as non-coincident freedom -> facticity/transcendence tension -> deny one pole -> bad faith -> alienation -> difficult authenticity.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Bad faith is not a lie told by one inner agent to another but a unified flight from the facticity-transcendence tension, while authenticity remains the difficult task of owning both without pretending that freedom or situation can be abolished.**

## 08 — SARTRE: THE LOOK, SHAME, BEING-FOR-OTHERS AND SOCIAL LIMIT

LOOK / SHAME / OBJECTIFICATION · BEING-FOR-OTHERS · CONFLICT AND ALIENATION · NOT EVERY RELATION IS HELL · COLLECTIVE AGENCY QUALIFIES

**BEING-FOR-OTHERS → the self as object for another free subject.** → **KEYHOLE → absorbed project; footsteps interrupt and reveal that I am seen.** → **SHAME → recognition of myself as the Other sees me; not private embarrassment alone.** → **THE LOOK → another subject is lived through objectification, not merely inferred.** → **OBJECT-FOR-ANOTHER → I acquire an outside and meanings I do not control.**

### DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- BEING-FOR-OTHERS → the self as object for another free subject.
- KEYHOLE → absorbed project; footsteps interrupt and reveal that I am seen.
- SHAME → recognition of myself as the Other sees me; not private embarrassment alone.
- THE LOOK → another subject is lived through objectification, not merely inferred.
- OBJECT-FOR-ANOTHER → I acquire an outside and meanings I do not control.

### OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- CONFLICT → possess the Other's freedom or reduce the Other to an object; both fail.
- ALIENATION → freedom is exposed to another freedom's meanings and judgments.
- OBJECTION → love, care, trust and solidarity challenge universal conflict.
- LATER SARTRE → group-in-fusion admits forms of collective, non-isolated agency.
- PYQ 2018 → inauthenticity + bad faith → alienation across Heidegger and Sartre.

### REPLY / RESIDUAL

- PYQ 2023 → for-itself, nihilation and non-self-identity ground the bad-faith route.
- ADVANCED → Levinas, care and collective agency qualify conflict; optional, not core.
- VERDICT → decisive account of shame; incomplete theory of reciprocal social life.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Absorbed project -> another's Look -> shame -> being-for-others -> failed recognition -> conflict -> later social qualification.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Look reveals the Other as the subject for whom I am an object, making shame a genuine disclosure of being-for-others while leaving open whether conflict exhausts human relations.**

## 09 — COMPARISON, EXACT DISTINCTIONS, CRITICISM AND ANSWER SPINE

K / H / S COMPARISON · EIGHT EXACT DISTINCTIONS · CRITICISM -> REPLY -> RESIDUAL · NO FLATTENING · EXAM ANSWER SPINE

**KIERKEGAARD → religious inward commitment and the self responsibly before God.** → **HEIDEGGER → ontological analysis of finite, thrown being-in-the-world.** → **SARTRE → atheistic freedom, nothingness, responsibility, bad faith and the Look.** → **ANXIETY → possibility / world-collapse / unsupported freedom across the three projects.** → **EXACT PAIRS → fear/anxiety; facticity/determinism; freedom/power.**

### SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- KIERKEGAARD → religious inward commitment and the self responsibly before God.
- HEIDEGGER → ontological analysis of finite, thrown being-in-the-world.
- SARTRE → atheistic freedom, nothingness, responsibility, bad faith and the Look.
- ANXIETY → possibility / world-collapse / unsupported freedom across the three projects.
- EXACT PAIRS → fear/anxiety; facticity/determinism; freedom/power.

### DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- EXACT PAIRS → authenticity/nonconformity; subjectivity/arbitrariness.
- EXACT PAIRS → being-in-world/containment; bad faith/lying; death/biological event.
- PYQ 2019/2022 → Dasein, authenticity, temporality and being-in-the-world.
- PYQ 2020/2022/2023/2024 → Kierkegaard: subjectivity, stages and anti-Hegelian self.
- PYQ 2019-2021/2024/2025 → Sartre: freedom, essence and in-itself/for-itself.

### EVALUATION / TRAP

- CORE → three projects plus the syllabus triad; sufficient without optional depth.
- ADVANCED → provenance, critics and later revisions sharpen a qualified evaluation.
- CRITIQUE → fideism; empty resoluteness; exaggerated freedom and thin ethics.
- ANSWER SPINE → define → locate project → argue → distinguish → object → reply → limit.
- VERDICT → one problem-field, three irreducible projects; preserve insight and difference.

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** Common problem -> thinker-specific ground -> mechanism -> consequence -> objection and reply -> exact distinctions -> comparative judgment.

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Existentialism's unity lies in making finite existence philosophically primary, while its strength lies in the very disagreements that prevent anxiety, authenticity, freedom and selfhood from collapsing into one slogan.**

## E — SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

EXTRA

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT! · ADVANCED SESSION 1 — FOUNDATIONAL MAP - THREE THINKERS · ADVANCED SESSION 2 — KIERKEGAARD - THE SINGLE INDIVIDUAL · ADVANCED SESSION 3 — HEIDEGGER I - DASEIN AND · WORLDHOOD, EQUIPMENT, THE EXISTENTIALIA AND CARE · ADVANCED SESSION 4 — HEIDEGGER II - AUTHENTICITY AND · DAS MAN, FALLING, THE CALL OF CONSCIENCE AND BEING-TOWARD-DEATH · ADVANCED SESSION 5 — HEIDEGGER III - TEMPORALITY (ZEITLICHKEIT)

### OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- ADVANCED SESSION 1 — Foundational Map - Three Thinkers, One Shared Conviction, Radical Differences
- ADVANCED SESSION 2 — Kierkegaard - The Single Individual, Truth Is Subjectivity, the Three Stages, the Leap and Indirect Communication
- ADVANCED SESSION 3 — Heidegger I - Dasein and Being-in-the-World: Worldhood, Equipment, the Existentialia and Care
- ADVANCED SESSION 4 — Heidegger II - Authenticity and Inauthenticity: das Man, Falling, the Call of Conscience and Being-toward-Death

### ADVANCED OBJECTION

- ADVANCED SESSION 5 — Heidegger III - Temporality (Zeitlichkeit): the Three Ecstases, Future-Priority, and Primordial versus Vulgar Time
- ADVANCED SESSION 6 — Existence and Essence - Sartre's Slogan, the Paper-Knife, and Heidegger's Rejection of Humanism
- ADVANCED SESSION 7 — Sartre I - Radical Freedom, Choice, Responsibility, and the Moods of Anguish, Abandonment and Despair
- ADVANCED SESSION 8 — Sartre II - Bad Faith, Facticity/Transcendence, and the Pour-soi / En-soi Ontology

### COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- ADVANCED SESSION 9 — Sartre III - The Look (le regard), Being-for-Others, Shame, and the Conflict of Recognition
- ADVANCED SESSION 10 — Comparison and Answer Spine - Fear versus Angst across the Three Thinkers, and the Cross-Thinker Synthesis
- ADVANCED DOSSIER REFINEMENTS — USE SELECTIVELY
- The shared thesis is about priority , not a shared slogan.

**OPTIONAL STATUS —** This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels